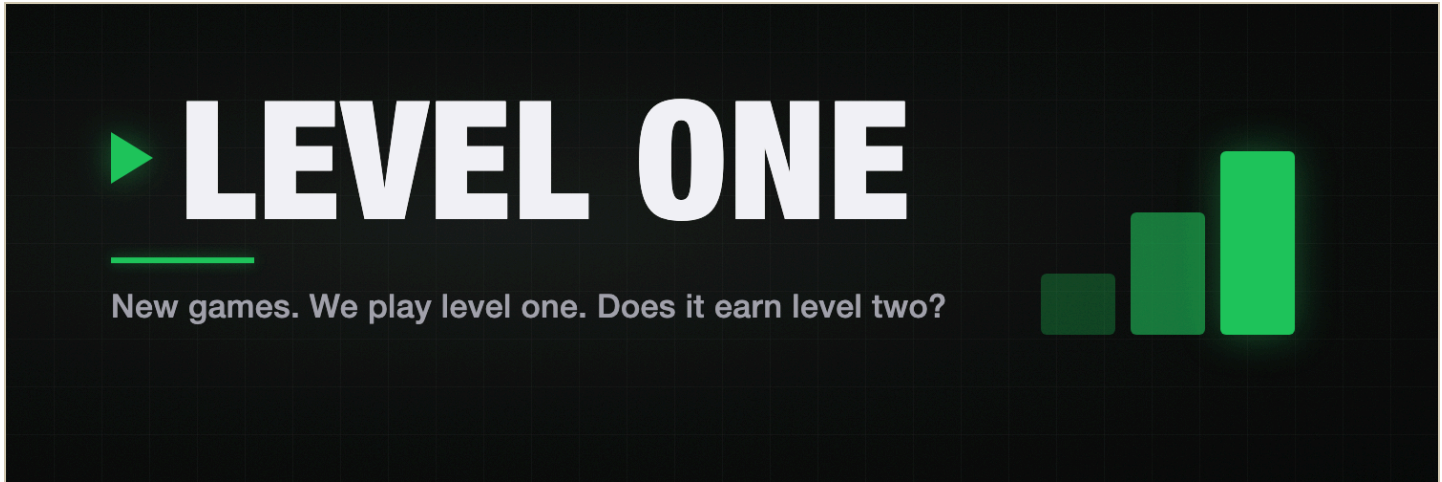


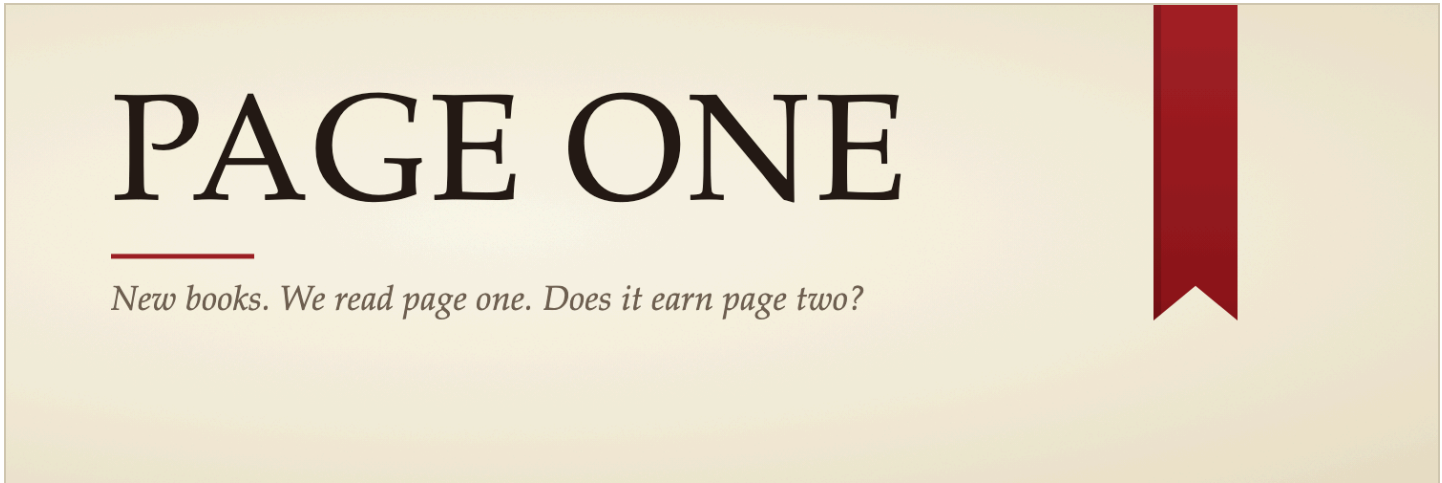
LEVEL ONE / PAGE ONE

*Two sibling curation brands. One question each:
does level one earn level two, and does page one
earn page two?*

The cover art for 'LEVEL ONE' features a dark background with a grid of squares. A green play button icon is on the left. The title 'LEVEL ONE' is in large, bold, white letters. Below the title is a green horizontal line. To the right is a bar chart with three green bars of increasing height. The text 'New games. We play level one. Does it earn level two?' is at the bottom.

▶ LEVEL ONE

New games. We play level one. Does it earn level two?

The cover art for 'PAGE ONE' has a light beige background. The title 'PAGE ONE' is in large, black, serif letters. Below the title is a red horizontal line. On the right is a red bookmark ribbon. The text 'New books. We read page one. Does it earn page two?' is at the bottom.

PAGE ONE

New books. We read page one. Does it earn page two?

31 JULY 2026

BRAND KIT + BOTH WEEK-ONE QUEUES

CONTENT BANKED, LAUNCH BLOCKED

We are starting two recommendation accounts, not two advertising accounts. Level One plays the first level of somebody else's new game and says whether it earned the second. Page One reads the first page of somebody else's new book and says whether it earned the second. Four out of every five features are other people's work. That ratio is not modesty, it is the entire mechanism: an account that only sells its own thing has no audience, and an account that hands people something good every week builds one.

Everything in this document already exists as a file. The brand kit is built, both week-one queues are written and fact-checked, and the message to Wyatt's dad is drafted and ready to send. Nothing here has been posted, and no creator has been contacted.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT CONTAINS

§ 01-02	Why the format is shaped this way, and the five rules nobody breaks.
§ 03-04	The two brands: identity, voice, and the post template each one repeats.
§ 05-06	Launch mechanics. Account setup, the anti-bot sequence, follow lists, first post.
§ 07-08	Week one, fully written. Nine cards per brand, paste-ready, sources recorded.
§ 09	The Page One dependency: the intake message for Wyatt's dad.
§ 10-11	What we found the hard way, what has a deadline, and who owns the next move.

TWO THINGS ARE BLOCKING LAUNCH, BOTH HUMAN-ONLY

1. The two X signups. Phone verification cannot be automated and account creation is a human action under X's terms. Everything needed is in § 05, paste-ready. **Deadline: do the Level One signup by roughly 4 August** – the Day 2 Kickstarter card expires 6 August.

2. The text to dad. Page One's scope is locked to his genre on purpose, and we do not know his genre yet. The message is written verbatim in § 09 and takes one minute to send.

A curation brand, not a megaphone

The instinct with a new game or a new book is to build an account that talks about it. That account does not grow, because nobody follows a commercial. The alternative is to build something with genuine editorial value, earn an audience with it, and let our own work arrive to people who already trust the taste. It is the long way around and it is the only way that works.

The growth loop

Every feature is designed to fire a four-step loop. This is the whole engine, and it is why tagging the creator is a rule rather than a courtesy.

STEP ONE	STEP TWO	STEP THREE	STEP FOUR
Feature	Tag	They reshare	Their audience follows
Play level one or read page one for real. Post a specific verdict with an image.	Name the creator's own account in the post. They are half the audience.	Creators reshare genuine praise. It costs them nothing and flatters them accurately.	Their readers and players meet an account with taste. Some stay.

THE LOOP IS MUCH WEAKER ON THE BOOK SIDE, AND WE KNOW THE NUMBER

Of the nine authors queued for Page One week one, exactly **two** have an X handle discoverable from their own website. The other seven list Instagram only, or no socials at all. On the games side effectively every developer has an X account linked from their own Steam page. So the loop fires on roughly **2 of 7** book posts versus close to **7 of 7** game posts. This is the single most important structural finding in the work so far. It means Instagram cross-posting is not optional garnish for Page One, it is where the amplifier actually lives, and it makes the Bluesky mirror far more valuable for books than for games. See § 10.

The father-and-son structure is the story

A working novelist reading first pages and a working game designer playing first levels is not two accounts that happen to share a template. It is one idea with two rooms. Each account credibly says the thing that recommendation accounts almost never credibly say: *I do this for a living, so I know what a good opening costs*. Each also cross-refers to the other in its bio, so a follower of one meets the other.

What this realistically does, and what it does not

It does not produce a thousand Kickstarter backers on its own inside a month. Email converts at roughly five percent and Kickstarter followers at fifteen to twenty-five. What it does is compound: it builds an owned audience that is warm before a campaign starts, and it warms the exact tabletop-backer audience by including tabletop Kickstarters in Level One's scope. The honest framing is that this is the marketing leg of the plan, and it pays off across campaigns rather than inside one.

NINETY-DAY CHECKPOINT · 1 NOVEMBER 2026

One of: at least 1,500 followers, or one video past 50,000 views, or 250 newsletter subscribers. Hit it and we double down. Miss it and we change the format, not the goal.

These apply to both brands and they are not negotiable. Every one of them exists because breaking it kills the thing that makes the account worth following.

R1 Positive only. Skip, never pan.

Feature what we would genuinely recommend. If level one does not earn level two, we say nothing at all. Silence is the review. This is not politeness, it is what makes a positive verdict mean something.

R2 Eighty / twenty.

At least four of every five features are other people's work. The moment that ratio slips, the account becomes an advertisement and the audience leaves.

R3 Disclose ours, first line, every time.

Anything from Corkscrew or from dad opens with "Full disclosure: this one is ours." Not a footnote, not a reply. The first line.

R4 Image or clip on every post.

No visual, no post. The only exception in the entire system is the pinned first post, which is allowed to stand on text alone.

R5 Encouraging and accurate at the same time.

Praise what is really there, never what is not. We never claim to have played or read what we have not. A trailer impression is labelled as a trailer impression, and a premise reaction is labelled as a premise reaction.

TWO MECHANICAL RULES THAT ARE EASY TO FORGET

No em dashes, anywhere in post copy. Regular hyphens if a dash is needed at all. Every file in this package has been checked programmatically for this. It is the fastest tell that copy was machine-written.

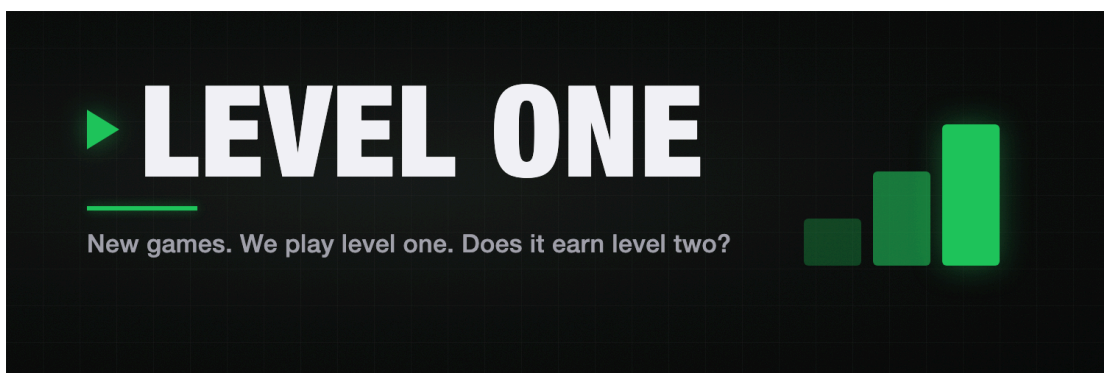
No hashtag piles. Zero or one, and only when it genuinely helps.



Avatar, 400 × 400.

Banner, 1500 × 500.

Both in /brand/assets/



THE VOICE

A game designer who ships his own games, playing everyone else's first level with real curiosity. Sounds like a sharp friend at a demo night: quick verdict, specific reason, zero snark. Excited when something is good, silent when it is not. Never corporate, never a hype machine, never a critic with a rubric.

The only question that matters: does level one earn level two?

THE RECURRING FORMAT

TEMPLATE

```
LEVEL ONE, no. 14
[Game] by @[dev]
Verdict: the grappling hook alone is worth the install.
For fans of: [comp].
Out now on [platforms].
(30s clip or screenshot attached)
```

Numbered like issues so the feed reads as a running series. The verdict names the exact thing that earned level two: a mechanic, a feel, a moment. Not adjectives.

FIVE DOS

1. Play level one for real before posting. The verdict quotes what happened in your hands.
2. Attach a clip or screenshot every single time. No image, no post.
3. Tag the dev. They are the amplifier and half the audience.
4. Open with "Full disclosure: this one is ours." on any Corkscrew game, first line, every time.
5. Keep at least 4 of every 5 features other people's games. The 80/20 rule is the brand.

FIVE DON'TS

1. Never pan a game. If level one does not earn level two, skip it. Silence is the review.
2. Never claim we played what we only watched. A trailer impression gets labelled as one.
3. No hashtag piles. Zero or one, and only when it truly helps.
4. No em dashes, no corporate phrasing, no "excited to announce."
5. No drama, no dunks, no discourse. We are the friend with good taste, not the referee.

SCOPE NOTE: TABLETOP IS DELIBERATELY INSIDE THE TENT

Level One covers indie, mobile *and* tabletop, including live Kickstarter campaigns. That is not scope creep. It warms the precise audience that a Boo! campaign needs, months before that campaign opens, and it does so by being useful to them rather than by asking them for anything.



Avatar, 400 × 400.

Banner, 1500 × 500.

Both in /brand/assets/



THE VOICE

A working novelist reading everyone else's first pages the way he has read his own for years: closely, hopefully, out of love for the craft. Sounds like a well-read friend handing you a book already open: warm, precise, a little wry, allergic to blurb-speak. Never academic, never gushing, never cruel.

The only question that matters: does page one earn page two?

THE RECURRING FORMAT

TEMPLATE

PAGE ONE, no. 6
 [Book] by [author]
 First line: "[quote]"
 Verdict: earns page two before the paragraph ends.
 For readers of: [comp].
 (cover attached)

The first-line quote is the hook. The verdict says what the prose actually did, not how it made us feel in general.

FIVE DOS

1. Read page one for real before posting. Every verdict is earned on the page.
2. Attach the cover every single time. No image, no post.
3. Tag the author when they are on X. They reshare, their readers follow.
4. Open with "Full disclosure: this one is ours." on dad's book, first line, every time.
5. Keep at least 4 of every 5 features other people's books. 80/20, always.

FIVE DON'TS

1. Never pan a book. If page one does not earn page two, skip it. Silence, not snark.
2. Never claim we read what we did not. A cover-and-premise note gets labelled as one.
3. No hashtag piles. Zero or one, and only when it truly helps.
4. No em dashes, no blurb-speak, no "a triumph."
5. No spoilers past page one and no plot summaries. We sell the door, not the house.

THE FIRST-LINE QUOTE RULE IS THE ENTIRE CREDIBILITY OF THIS BRAND

Every quoted first line must be read in a real, publisher-authorised sample of the actual book. Not from memory, not reconstructed, not paraphrased, and not lifted from a third-party excerpt page without checking. This rule applies to dad's book exactly as strictly as it applies to a stranger's. If there is no public sample of his opening, his card gets premise-based copy that says so.

Launch • the two signups

Roughly ten minutes per account. Do the two signups on different days, or at the very least several hours apart, from the same home network you will normally post from. Both follow lists below were verified live on 31 July 2026.

Card 1 • Level One

DISPLAY NAME	Level One
HANDLE, 1ST CHOICE	@LevelOnePlays
HANDLE BACKUPS	@LevelOneDaily, then @PlaysLevelOne
SIGN UP WITH EMAIL	wyatt+levelone@corkscrewgames.com
PASSWORD MANAGER	Save the entry "X - Level One" before closing the tab
AVATAR / BANNER	levelone-avatar.png / levelone-banner.png
LOCATION	Florida, or leave blank
WEBSITE FIELD	Leave blank (X only for now)

Plus-addressing means all X mail lands in the normal inbox with zero admin. A real levelone@ alias can be added in Workspace later without touching the account.

BIO, PASTE AS-IS • 156 CHARACTERS

PASTE

We play level one of a new game and tell you if it earns level two. Indie, mobile, tabletop. Run by a game designer who ships. Sister account: @PageOneReads

If Page One does not exist yet, paste the bio anyway. The handle link goes live when the sibling account is created.

Card 2 • Page One

DISPLAY NAME	Page One
HANDLE, 1ST CHOICE	@PageOneReads
HANDLE BACKUPS	@PageOneDaily, then @ReadsPageOne
SIGN UP WITH EMAIL	wyatt+pageone@corkscrewgames.com
PASSWORD MANAGER	Save the entry "X - Page One" before closing the tab
AVATAR / BANNER	pageone-avatar.png / pageone-banner.png
LOCATION	Florida, or leave blank
WEBSITE FIELD	Leave blank (X only for now)

PASTE

A working novelist reads page one of a new book and tells you if it earns page two. New releases, one verdict at a time. Sister account: @LevelOnePlays

The anti-bot sequence

Run this in order on each account. A brand-new account that follows a pile of people and immediately posts a link is the exact shape of a spam bot, and X treats it accordingly.

- 1
- Create the account with the email above. Verify phone when asked.
- 2
- Complete the profile fully before doing anything else** — avatar, banner, bio, location. A finished profile is the single best bot-flag repellent.
- 3
- Follow 10 to 15 accounts from the list below. Not all 17 at once.
- 4
- Wait at least 3 to 4 hours. Close the tab. Walk away.
- 5
- Then make the first post (§ 06). No links in the very first post.
- 6
- Pin it.

Optional on both: X Premium at roughly \$8/month buys reply visibility, which matters more than usual for a curation account. Works fine without it.

Level One · first-day follow list

HANDLE	WHAT IT IS	WHY FOLLOW ON DAY ONE
@_wholesomegames	Cozy indie curator	Model curator; Wholesome Direct feeds cozy first-level picks
@gameralphabeta	Demo and beta curator	Daily source of brand-new playable indie demos
@clemmygames	Indie showcase channel	Runs 2026 indie showcases; constant discovery pipeline
@rockpapershot	Rock Paper Shotgun	Indie-friendly PC coverage to track and share
@PocketGamer	Mobile games site	Core mobile press; weekly new-game roundups
@PoLygon	Games and culture outlet	Covers indies plus Gen Con tabletop news
@gamedevdotcom	Game Developer	Dev-side news and postmortems worth quoting
@GIBiz	GamesIndustry.biz	Industry and funding context for curation
@itchio	Indie marketplace	First-level demos and jams launch here daily
@Kickstarter	Crowdfunding platform	Where the tabletop campaigns we feature live
@dayofthedevs	Indie showcase nonprofit	Premier indie showcases
@IndieCade	Independent games festival	Digital plus physical indie coverage
@BoardGameGeek	Board game database	Tabletop hub; awards and Gen Con coverage
@TabletopMag	Tabletop Gaming Magazine	Active tabletop press replacing dormant Dicebreaker
@gamefound	Tabletop crowdfunding	Hosts top board game campaigns
@BackerKit	Crowdfunding platform	Big tabletop and zine campaigns launch here
@CMONGames	Miniatures publisher	Kickstarter powerhouse; SPIEL Essen 2026 plans

VERIFIED DEAD OR DEPARTED · DO NOT FOLLOW

TouchArcade (site shut down 2024), GameDiscoverCo (moved to Bluesky), Dicebreaker (mothballed), Stonemaier Games (dropped X), BoardGameWire (moved to Bluesky), the IGF news account (dormant), The Dice Tower (dropped X).

Page One · first-day follow list

HANDLE	WHAT IT IS	WHY FOLLOW ON DAY ONE
@goodreads	Reader reviews platform	Reader taste signals and new-release buzz at scale
@BookBub	Deals and recommendations	Cross-genre discovery trends
@thestorygraph	Reading tracker	Fast-growing community with fresh discovery data
@LibraryThing	Book cataloguing community	Veteran community and early reviewer programmes
@PublishersWkly	Publishers Weekly	Core industry news and prepub review pipeline
@KirkusReviews	Prepublication reviews	Prepub verdicts to compare against first-page reads
@thebookseller	UK publishing trade	UK deals ahead of US coverage
@ShelfAwareness	Bookselling news	Daily new-title and bookstore digest
@pubperspectives	Publishing Perspectives	Global rights and market context
@LondonBookFair	Publishing trade fair	Season calendar and rights buzz
@WritersDigest	Craft magazine	Craft content and large writer-audience overlap
@thecreativepenn	Joanna Penn	Indie publishing trends from a working novelist
@ReedsyHQ	Author services hub	Author community events and how-tos
@awpwriter	AWP	Literary community, conference and prize news
@parisreview	The Paris Review	Craft interviews pair well with first-page verdicts
@TheTLS	Times Literary Supplement	Serious review culture and prize coverage
@LARreviewofBooks	LA Review of Books	Coverage beyond New York

VERIFIED DEAD OR DEPARTED · DO NOT FOLLOW

Literary Hub (Bluesky only), Book Riot (dropped X), Electric Literature (announced exit), Authors Guild (left X 2025), Jane Friedman (dropped X), NYT Books (inactive), NetGalley (silent since early 2025), The Millions (dormant), NPR Books (NPR quit X), NaNoWriMo (organisation shut down 2025).

That ten-name dead list on the books side is itself evidence for the finding in § 01: the literary world has substantially left X.

The pinned post

The pinned post is the first post. It goes up after the three-to-four hour wait, then gets pinned. No links in it. This is the one post in the entire system allowed to stand without an image.

Level One

PRIMARY

New games. We play level one. If it earns level two, we tell you exactly why. If it does not, we say nothing at all.

Run by a game designer who ships his own. Expect indie, mobile, and tabletop finds, with a clip every time.

Send us your game.

ALTERNATE A · SHORTER, COLDER OPEN

We play level one of new games. Earn level two and the timeline hears about it. Fail and nothing happens. No reviews, no dunks, just finds.

From a game designer who ships. Send us your game.

ALTERNATE B · PERSONAL VOICE

I make games for a living, and I still love the first ten minutes of someone else's more than anything. So: I play level one of a new game, and if it earns level two, I show you.

Devs, send me your level one.

Page One

PRIMARY

New books. We read page one. If it earns page two, we tell you exactly why. If it does not, we say nothing at all.

Run by a working novelist who has spent a lifetime on first pages. Every verdict is earned on the page.

Authors, send us your page one.

ALTERNATE A · SHORTER, COLDER OPEN

We read page one of new books. Earn page two and the timeline hears about it. Fail and nothing happens. No takedowns, just finds.

From a working novelist. Send us your page one.

ALTERNATE B · DAD SPEAKING

I am a novelist. I have rewritten my own first pages more times than I can count, so I know what a good one costs. Now I read everyone else's: one new book, one page, one verdict.

If it earns page two, you will hear about it.

Check before posting any of these: no links in the first post, image optional on this one only, and never edit in an em dash.

Week one • Level One

Nine cards: seven days plus two spares. Every factual claim – title spelling, developer name, platform, release date, Kickstarter funding state – was verified against the listed primary source on 31 July 2026, live, not from memory.

HOW TO USE THESE

Copy the post block as-is, attach the image, post. Every post is budgeted to fit X's 280-character free-account limit with the link counting 23 characters and the verdict running up to about 120. The "no. N" counter numbers features in posting order; if a spare replaces a day, it inherits that day's number.

Verdict slots are deliberately blank on the games we can play. Wyatt writes the verdict after ten real minutes in the game. The Kickstarter cards carry premise-based verdicts instead, written honestly as reactions to a pitch. **No card claims we played anything.**

DAY	GAME	DEVELOPER	SLOT LOGIC
1	Denshattack!	Undercoders	Strongest visual hook. A train doing skateboard tricks.
2	Button Kingdoms	Around the Stump	Kickstarter card inside the first 3 days. Ends 6 Aug.
3	Wish Upon a Cat	Odenecat	Mobile, free to try. Widest possible install funnel.
4	Sephiria	TEAM HORAY	Just hit 1.0 the day this queue was drafted.
5	Green vs Tan (ours)	Corkscrew Games	Not before day 4, per the rule. Disclosure line first.
6	How to Raise Your Kaiju	Rose Gauntlet	Second KS card, runway to 13 Aug.
7	Minato	noshuio (solo)	Free in-browser. Cleanest call to action of the week.
A	En-nichi!	Mugen Gaming	Spare. Swaps for Day 2 if that campaign closes first.
B	Akatori	Contrast Games	Spare. Valid from 5 Aug only, releases that day.

Six of the seven day-posts are other people's games. Green vs Tan is the one in seven, which holds the 80/20 rule.

DAY 1 Denshattack!

@Denshattack

DEV Undercoders, a small Barcelona studio. Published by Fireshine and Boltray.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. 1
Denshattack! by @Denshattack
Verdict: [WYATT - play 10 min, one line, ~120 chars max]
For fans of: Tony Hawk, if the skateboard was a train.
Out now on Steam.
<https://store.steampowered.com/app/2524850/Denshattack/>

IMAGE Official Steam header art. Better: capture a 5 to 10 second trick clip while playing.

NOTE Released 15 July, inside the 30-day window. It is the least undiscovered pick of the week at 1,907 reviews, traded deliberately for launch-day stopping power and instant taste credibility. The rest of the week goes smaller. Price stays out of the post so a sale cannot date it.

DAY 2 Button Kingdoms

@Outrunbeargame

DEV Around the Stump Games, a Tucson micro-publisher on its second campaign.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. 2
Button Kingdoms by @Outrunbeargame
Verdict: plush-army deck-building where bribery is a real rule, a game of fluff and corruption in their own words. The pitch earns a follow.
Live on Kickstarter through Aug 6, 6x funded.
<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/aroundthestumpgames/button-kingdoms-conquest-through-cuddles>

VERIFIED \$49,682 pledged of \$7,750, 513 backers, deadline 6 Aug, a Kickstarter "Project We Love." Cross-checked on Kicktraq.

NOTE **Hard deadline.** The campaign ends 6 August, so this card must go up by 5 August. If the account is not live in time, swap in Spare A and drop this card. Premise verdict only; "fluff and corruption" is their own site tagline.

DAY 3

Wish Upon a Cat

@OdenCatGames

DEV OdenCat Inc., a small Japanese studio. Bear's Restaurant, Meg's Monster.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. 3

Wish Upon a Cat by @OdenCatGames

Verdict: [WYATT - play 10 min, one line, ~120 chars max]

For fans of: A Short Hike.

Out now on iOS and Android, free to try.

<https://apps.apple.com/us/app/wish-upon-a-cat/id6762931494>

NOTE Released 23 July, 4.9 stars from 48 ratings at draft time. Monetisation is kind: free, one \$0.99 ad removal, optional tip jar. The verdict lands best if it names a moment rather than the nostalgia.

DAY 4

Sephiria

@TeamHoray

DEV TEAM HORAY, a small South Korean team. Made Dungreed. Self-published.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. 4

Sephiria by @TeamHoray

Verdict: [WYATT - play 10 min, one line, ~120 chars max]

For fans of: Dungreed and bunny knights.

Just hit 1.0 on Steam. Windows and Mac.

<https://store.steampowered.com/app/2436940/Sephiria/>

NOTE 1.0 landed the day this queue was drafted, so "just hit 1.0" stays true all week. Fifteen months in early access; the post avoids a month count to stay paste-safe. Intro sale runs to 10 Aug if price is wanted in a reply.

DAY 5

Green vs Tan • this one is ours

DEV Corkscrew Games. No tag needed, it is our own studio's game.

Use the variant matching App Store status. iOS 1.0 was still awaiting review when this was drafted, so start on Variant A and switch the day approval lands.

VARIANT A • IOS STILL IN REVIEW

Full disclosure: this one is ours.
Green vs Tan. Toy soldiers, one long front, the whole line fires. Free in your browser, no download, from our one-man studio.
Level one below. Tell us if it earns level two.
<https://playgvt.net>

VARIANT B • AFTER APPLE APPROVES

Full disclosure: this one is ours.
Green vs Tan. Toy soldiers, one long front, the whole line fires. Free on iPhone as of this week, from our one-man studio.
Level one below. Tell us if it earns level two.
<https://apps.apple.com/app/id6793353373>

NOTE The disclosure line comes first, which is also why this card carries no "no. N" header. Day 5 respects the "no earlier than day 4" rule with curation credibility banked first. **The domain is playgvt.net, not .com** — see § 10. If approval slips, replace "as of this week" with "out now on iPhone".

DAY 6

How to Raise Your Kaiju

@RoseGauntlet

DEV Rose Gauntlet Entertainment. Isaac Vega and Lindsey Rode. Wild Gardens, Keystone.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. 5
How to Raise Your Kaiju by @RoseGauntlet
Verdict: raise a baby kaiju, conquer cities, earn gold stars for parenting. The premise earns the click.
Live on Kickstarter through Aug 13, 3x funded.
<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/rosegauklet/how-to-raise-your-kaiju>

VERIFIED \$31,240 pledged of \$10,000, 380 backers, deadline 13 Aug.

NOTE Safely mid-campaign, a week past this queue. Established small studio with a real reshare habit, which is exactly the follow-loop profile. Premise verdict only.

DAY 7

Minato

@noshuio

DEV noshuio, solo developer, Italy.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. 6

Minato by @noshuio

Verdict: [WYATT - play 10 min in the browser, one line, ~120 chars max]

For fans of: Minesweeper and roguelikes.

Free in your browser now. Steam on the way.

<https://noshuio.itch.io/minato>

NOTE The wildcard. "Minesweeper but it's a roguelike" is the developer's own one-liner and the whole pitch. Playable free in any browser, which is the cleanest possible call to action for a young account. 4.7 stars from 347 ratings.

SPARE A

En-nichi!

no X handle

DEV Mugen Gaming, a Kansas City localiser of Japanese tabletop games.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. [inherit slot]

En-nichi! by Mugen Gaming

Verdict: a Japanese summer festival in a box, lanterns, drums and fireworks included. The theme alone earns a look.

Live on Kickstarter through Aug 13, 12x funded.

<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/mugengaming/en-nichi-a-cozy-matsuri-board-game>

NOTE First-choice replacement if Button Kingdoms closes before the account is live. \$97,876 pledged of \$7,878. No developer tag is possible, which weakens the reshare loop, and that is precisely why it is a spare rather than a weekday.

DEV Contrast Games. Published by Games Harbor and Esprit Games.

POST

LEVEL ONE, no. [inherit slot]
Akatori by @AKATORIGAME
Verdict: [WYATT - play 10 min, one line, ~120 chars max]
For fans of: metroidvanias and Neo Geo color.
Out August 5 on Steam.
<https://store.steampowered.com/app/1442520/Akatori/>

NOTE Do not post before 5 August. It releases that day and the verdict slot needs the game playable first. If the date slips, hold it and re-check the page.

BENCH FOR WEEK TWO, VERIFIED THE SAME DAY

Kusan: City of Wolves (Steam, 30 July) · Cat Mail Co. (Steam, 9 July) · Below, Rusted Gods (Steam and itch, 29 July) · BLOWOUT. (free browser, a GMTK jam standout).

Nine cards: seven days plus two spares. Every first line below was read in a real publisher-authorised sample of the actual book – a Google Books preview, a publisher excerpt page, or the publisher's own embedded sample reader. Not one quote came from memory.

TWO DIFFERENCES FROM THE LEVEL ONE QUEUE

The verdicts are written, not left blank. The rule for this brand is that a verdict must be earned by the text, and the text was read, so each verdict names the specific thing the opening does. Dad should still say it in his own words. His voice is the product; these are a floor, not a script.

No links in the post body. The cover image is the only attachment, so the post never truncates and does not get downranked for an outbound link. The buy link goes in the first reply.

DAY	BOOK	AUTHOR	SLOT	TAG
1	Famous Men	Julie Buntin	Literary	none found
2	The Death Row Club	V. A. Vazquez	Thriller, debut	none found
3	The Witch Below the Dreaming Wood	H. G. Parry	Fantasy	@hg_parry
4	Yes, Chef	Grace Reilly	Romance	none found
5	All That's Unseen	Emilee Hackney	Memoir, debut	none found
6	The Seekers of Deer Creek	Thao Thai	Book club	@thaozer
7	Paradise Pawn	Meg Richardson	Debut wildcard	none found
A	Should the Waters Take Us	Stephanie Soileau	Literary, debut	none found
B	Unsayable	Michael Cunningham	Memoir	none found

Four of the nine are debut authors. All nine were published or go on sale between 14 July and 4 August 2026, so the whole queue sits inside the freshness window.

DAY 1 Famous Men

Julie Buntin

SOURCE Google Books publisher-authorised preview, page 3. Cross-checked against the Random House excerpt on Lit Hub, identical.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 1

Famous Men by Julie Buntin

First line: "He doesn't remember me, but I know who he is."

Verdict: one sentence, and the entire power imbalance of the book is already sitting on the table.

For readers of: Trust Exercise, My Dark Vanessa.

FACTS Random House, on sale 14 July 2026, hardcover \$30.00, 400 pages.

NOTE The strongest opening line of the nine and the reason it leads the week: short enough to read in full at a glance in a feed. The narrator is Wilhelmina Miles and "he" is the biographer, not the famous man, which is good reply material.

DAY 2 The Death Row Club

V. A. Vazquez

SOURCE Google Books preview, prologue, page 1. Printed with a drop cap and the first four words in small capitals, which is typesetting, not spelling.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 2

The Death Row Club by V. A. Vazquez

First line: "We're eating dinner when our front door explodes."

Verdict: dinner and a detonation in one breath. You are at that table before you agreed to be.

For readers of: Karin Slaughter, who blurbed it.

FACTS Gallery/Scout Press, on sale 14 July 2026, hardcover \$29.00, 336 pages.

NOTE A debut, which is exactly the kind of author who reshapes hardest, so the missing X handle stings here more than anywhere else in the week. Worth cross-posting to Instagram and tagging @vavazquezwrites there. The premise is grim; the brand rule is positive-only about quality, not about subject matter.

DAY 3 The Witch Below the Dreaming Wood

@hg_parry

SOURCE The publisher's own excerpt page at Hachette, confirmed against the Google Books preview of the printed book.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 3

The Witch Below the Dreaming Wood by @hg_parry

First line: "When we were children under the Lake, my mother would tuck us into bed every night with the same words."

Verdict: a lullaby, until you notice where they sleep.

For readers of: The Once and Future King.

FACTS Redhook, an imprint of Hachette, on sale 21 July 2026, trade paperback \$19.99, 448 pages.

NOTE The comp is the publisher's own copy, not a guess. The narrator is Nimue and her mother is Morgan le Fay, which is the reveal three paragraphs in and should stay out of the post. **One of only two taggable authors this week**, so reply promptly if she reshapes.

DAY 4 Yes, Chef

Grace Reilly

SOURCE Google Books preview, prologue. The page before it is the table of contents, so this is the first line of the book.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 4

Yes, Chef by Grace Reilly

First line: "For the record, I don't mean for the shrimp to hit Jack Hartman in the face."

Verdict: damage control before you know what the damage is. Funny and guilty at once.

For readers of: grumpy sunshine kitchen romance.

FACTS Avon, an imprint of HarperCollins, on sale 21 July 2026, paperback \$18.99, 384 pages.

NOTE The only laugh in the week's queue, which is why it sits mid-week between two heavier books. The comp line is factual: the cover subtitle is "A Grumpy x Sunshine Kitchen Romance." Reilly is the most established name here and least likely to reshare, so feature her for the audience, not the amplification.

SOURCE Google Books publisher-authorised preview, prologue, page 1.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 5

All That's Unseen by Emilee Hackney

First line: "The church is in the shadow of a mountain, bordered by forest, a trailer park, and a creek that floods the parking lot every time it rains."

Verdict: no people in it yet, and you know the place.

FACTS Penguin Press, on sale 28 July 2026. Full title carries the subtitle "An Appalachian Memoir"; the post drops it for length, which is normal and not a misquote.

NOTE Newest book in the queue and the strongest 80/20 pick of the week: eighth-generation Appalachian, debut memoirist, effectively no social presence. Exactly the writer this brand exists to hand a reader to. **The only post of the nine with no "For readers of" line**, deliberately: at 137 characters this first line is by far the longest, and the comp would push past 280. Put "For readers of: Educated, Heartland." in the first reply instead.

SOURCE The publisher's own embedded sample reader, prologue headed 1998. Cross-checked against the Lit Hub excerpt, identical.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 6

The Seekers of Deer Creek by @thaozer

First line: "They are running again."

Verdict: four words, and "again" is carrying every one of them. You are already asking what happened the last time.

For readers of: Banyan Moon, by the same author.

FACTS Mariner Books, an imprint of HarperCollins, on sale 4 August 2026, hardcover \$30.00, 320 pages.

NOTE **Timing.** This book is not out until 4 August. If day 6 lands before that, either say "out August 4" in the first reply or swap in a spare and move this to the following week. Do not let the post imply it is buyable when it is not. Second of the two taggable authors.

SOURCE Google Books preview, Chapter 1. The preceding page is the dedication, so Chapter 1 is the start of the book.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. 7
Paradise Pawn by Meg Richardson
First line: "We make tons of money off of Christmas in July because everyone in Cherry Beach is lonely."
Verdict: a teenager explains her business model and gives away the whole town.
For readers of: a hustler with a soft center.

FACTS Tin House, on sale 14 July 2026, paperback \$18.00, 272 pages.

NOTE Small-press debut and the best week-one candidate for a genuine relationship with an author. **This card is also where the verification rule earned its keep** — see § 10.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. N
Should the Waters Take Us by Stephanie Soileau
First line: "The inhabitants of Chenière Disparue had a reputation for sloppy living."
Verdict: past tense, and a town whose name already means vanished.
For readers of: Louisiana across four centuries.

FACTS Doubleday, on sale 14 July 2026, hardcover \$30.00, 336 pages.

NOTE **Keep the accent on Chenière when pasting.** If the posting box mangles it, retype it rather than dropping it — a widely circulated excerpt prints the place name without its accent, and the printed book has it. "Disparue" is French for vanished, which is why the verdict works and is a good first-reply fact.

POST

PAGE ONE, no. N

Unsayable by Michael Cunningham

First line: "My earliest memory is a lack of language."

Verdict: a writer opening his own memoir at the exact spot where words were not available to him yet.

For readers of: The Hours, by the same author.

FACTS Random House, on sale 21 July 2026, hardcover \$30.00, 304 pages. Cunningham won the Pulitzer for The Hours, which is why that comp is factual rather than flattering.

NOTE The most famous name in the queue and therefore the one that least needs the boost, which is why it is a spare rather than a weekday. The opening section is titled "Names" and is about Tupperware, of all things, which is a genuinely charming reply if the post gets traction. **Warning in § 10 about a domain impersonating this author.**

The Page One dependency

Page One is deliberately locked to one genre: dad's. A niche builds trust, and every follower becomes a plausible reader of his book. We do not know the genre yet, so week two cannot be scoped until he answers ten questions. Week one is deliberately spread across literary fiction, thriller, fantasy, romance, memoir and a debut wildcard precisely because the answer has not come back.

The message, ready to send

Written to be sent as one text. If it is easier in two, break it at the blank line.

SEND AS-IS

Hey Dad. I want to build you something and I need about ten minutes of your answers to do it.

Here is the idea. You start an account called Page One where you read the first page of a new book and say in one line whether it earned page two. That is the whole format. It is your name, your taste, your voice, and it works because you are a working novelist and nobody else doing book recommendations is. I handle every piece of the machinery: I write the drafts, find the books, check the facts, get you the covers. You read, you decide, you say the line. About thirty minutes, three times a week.

Why it is worth your time: an account that only sells your own book has no audience. An account that hands people a good book every week builds one, and then your book arrives to people who already trust your taste. That is the long way around, and it is the only way that works.

So I can set it up right, can you answer these?

1. What is the exact title of the book, spelled the way it is on the cover?
2. What genre would a bookstore shelve it in?
3. Publisher, or did you publish it yourself? If a publisher, which one?
4. When does it come out, or when did it? Exact date if you have it.
5. What formats exist: ebook, print, audio?
6. Where can people buy it? Send me links if you have them.
7. How many reviews does it have right now, and where?
8. Do you already have a website, a newsletter, or any social accounts? Send handles even if you never use them.
9. Would you ever do voice or on-camera video, or do you want to stay text only? Either is fine and I will build around your answer.
10. Is there a sample chapter or excerpt of your book posted publicly anywhere?

No wrong answers on any of these and "I do not know" is a real answer. Just tell me what you have and I will do the rest.

WHY THE MESSAGE IS SHAPED THIS WAY

The pitch runs two sentences before the ask. It says out loud that Wyatt does the work, because the whole design depends on this costing dad close to nothing. It names the cadence – thirty minutes, three times a week – so nobody is surprised in a month.

What each answer unblocks

QUESTION	WHAT IT DECIDES
Q2 · genre	Page One's entire scope. Until it lands, week two cannot be picked. Once it does, week two narrows to his shelf and the spares get re-chosen.
Q3, 4, 7	Which short-game levers even exist. Review count and pub date decide BookBub eligibility and whether an ARC push is still possible or already too late. Self-published versus traditional changes who controls pricing and promotions.
Q8 · existing platform	Whether we are building or inheriting. An existing newsletter list, even a small one, is worth more than any follower count and changes the order of operations.
Q9 · voice or camera	The platform mix. Voice or camera means TikTok and Reels are open, which is where the actual reach is. Text only still works and simply changes what gets built.
Q10 · public excerpt	Whether his own book can ever run through the real Page One format with its first line quoted. No public sample, no quote. The accuracy rule applies to family too.

Worth repeating out loud: the first-line quote rule is the entire credibility of this brand, and it binds dad's book exactly as tightly as a stranger's. If there is no public sample of his opening, his card gets premise-based copy labelled as such, the same as any other book without a readable opening.

Findings, traps and deadlines

Things discovered while building this that change what we do, or that would have produced a wrong post if nobody had checked.

Dated, act on these

5 AUG

Level One must be live to run the Day 2 card

WYATT

The Button Kingdoms Kickstarter closes 6 August. Post it by 5 August or swap in Spare A and drop the card. This is the reason the Level One signup wants doing by roughly 4 August.

4 AUG

Page One Day 6 is not on sale until 4 August

CONTENT

The Seekers of Deer Creek. If day 6 falls earlier, either say "out August 4" in the first reply or move it to the following week. Never imply a book is buyable when it is not.

5 AUG

Spare B is not valid before 5 August

CONTENT

Akatori releases that day, and its verdict slot needs the game playable first.

Traps caught before they shipped

A REPUTABLE EXCERPT PAGE CAN STILL BE SHOWING YOU THE MIDDLE OF THE BOOK

A widely circulating excerpt of *Paradise Pawn* opens "When Dad and I went to Dallas for Mom's funeral." That is **not** the first line of the book, it is a later passage. The real Chapter 1 opening came from the actual book preview. This is exactly the failure mode the no-fabrication rule exists to catch, and the lesson generalises: always open the book, never trust an excerpt page to be the opening.

A SQUATTED DOMAIN IS IMPERSONATING ONE OF THE AUTHORS

The domain that looks like Michael Cunningham's author site is **not his**. It currently serves a Vietnamese sports-streaming site. Do not link it, do not cite it, and do not tag anything found on it. He has no locatable author website at all.

AN ACCENT THAT A THIRD-PARTY EXCERPT DROPS

Spare A quotes "Chenièrè Disparue." A circulating excerpt prints it without the accent; the printed book has it. Keep the accent when pasting, and retype it if the posting box mangles it. Small, but this brand's whole promise is that the quote is the quote.

OUR OWN DOMAIN WAS WRONG IN THE BRIEF

The Day 5 plan text said "playgvt.com". That domain does not resolve. **The live domain is playgvt.net**, verified serving the full game client. Worth knowing because it would have been a broken link in the one post that is ours.

The structural finding

LITERARY AUTHORS ARE LARGELY NOT ON X, AND IT CHANGES THE PAGE ONE PLAN

Two of nine queued authors have a discoverable X handle. Ten of the obvious book-world accounts we would have followed are dead, dormant, or have publicly left the platform. On the games side, effectively every developer links an X account from their own Steam page.

What follows from it: Instagram handles are recorded on every Page One card so the same feature can be cross-posted where the author actually is; the Bluesky mirror is far more valuable for Page One than for Level One and should probably move up the roadmap; and the reshare half of the growth loop simply cannot be relied on for books the way it can for games. **Under no circumstances do we guess or approximate a handle to fill the gap.** A wrong tag on a book account is the same class of error as a wrong quote.

Standing constraints

- **Account creation and posting are human-only.** Phone verification cannot be automated and automated posting is against X's terms. The pipeline produces files; a person posts them.
- **Nothing in this package has been posted and no creator has been contacted.** Every card is a draft sitting in a file.
- **Numbers that drift** – review counts, star ratings, pledge totals – live on the cards as at-draft-time context, never in post copy. The one exception is the Kickstarter "Nx funded" lines, which can only grow while a campaign is live.
- **Every post in both queues** fits 280 characters, carries zero hashtags, at most one tag, and contains no em dashes. All three were checked programmatically, not by eye.

Done and banked

DONE	Brand kit Voice guide, signup cards with verified follow lists, pinned posts, and four finished image assets for both accounts.	31 JUL
DONE	Level One week one Nine cards, every fact verified same-day against primary sources, verdict slots left for Wyatt to fill after real play.	31 JUL
DONE	Page One week one Nine cards with every first line read in a publisher-authorised sample and re-verified character for character.	31 JUL
DONE	Dad intake Send-as-is message plus a blank answer sheet, ready to drop straight into the next planning session.	31 JUL

Blocked, and on whom

BLOCKED	Create both X accounts Per § 05, following the numbered anti-bot sequence on each. Different days, or at least hours apart. Human-only: phone verification. Level One by roughly 4 August.	WYATT
BLOCKED	Text dad the intake The message in § 09, verbatim. His genre gates every Page One decision past week one.	WYATT
THEN	Fill the Level One verdict slots Ten real minutes per game, one line each. Four of the seven day-cards are waiting on this and cannot be written for him — the verdict is supposed to be what happened in his hands.	WYATT
THEN	Week two, both brands Level One's bench is already picked. Page One's week two cannot be scoped until dad's genre comes back.	CONTENT

THE HONEST READ

Two weeks of content are banked and nothing further is blocked on the content side. What stands between this and a live brand is about twenty minutes of human work: two signups and one text message. The only hard clock is 5 August, and it belongs to a single card.